Dilki Sewwandi

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Profile

Computer Science graduate and HCI researcher at the UCSC HCI Lab, working on **AI governance, trust, and safety**. I have published and presented at **ACM CHI 2025** and in the **Journal of Online Trust and Safety** at the **Stanford University Trust and Safety Research Conference**. My research looks at how AI and deepfakes are governed across South Asia, how **transparency signals such as AI-content labels and warnings** shape user trust and sharing behavior, and the role of detection technologies. Alongside this, I bring hands-on **software development experience**, and I want to help build platforms and technologies that are **safe and trustworthy** for the people who use them.

Education

- **University of Colombo School of Computing (UCSC), Sri Lanka**
  Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (Second Class Division) *2022 - 2025*
- **Sujatha Vidyalaya, Matara**
  G.C.E. Advanced Levels Combined Maths: A, Physics: B, Chemistry: B *2012 - 2020*

Research and Publications

- **Deepfakes in the Global South: Understanding Stakeholder Perceptions, Harms, and Governance Challenges in Sri Lanka, India, and Bangladesh**

  Comparative analysis of the legal, regulatory, and platform-level measures each country applies to deepfakes, identifying governance gaps (enforcement, detection capacity, platform accountability) that inform context-aware AI policy.

  - ***Published in Journal of Online Trust and Safety at the Stanford University.*** *[DOI]*

- **Labeling Synthetic Content: User Perceptions of Label Designs for AI-Generated Content on Social Media**

  Empirically evaluated label designs for disclosing AI-generated content, informing how AI provenance and transparency metadata should be surfaced to users.

  - ***Published in ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems 2025, Japan.*** *[DOI]*

- **Comparative Evaluation of Warning Label Formats in Mitigating Deepfake Sharing on Social Media**

  Experimental study measuring how different warning formats reduce users' intent to share synthetic media.

  - ***Working draft presented at ICWSM-Global 2025, Copenhagen, Denmark.*** *[Paper Link]*

- **Designing Cultural-Context-Aware Media Literacy Interventions for AI-Generated Content in the Global South**

  Lead author; designing and evaluating interventions that mitigate deepfake-related harm, grounded in local cultural context.

  - ***Manuscript under review at Computer Supported Cooperative Work Journal (CSCW).***

- **One Quarter of the World, Underserved: Deepfake Detection for South Asia**

  Lead author; a survey of current deepfake detection methods and technologies, including content provenance approaches, identifying where they fall short for South Asian languages, contexts, and populations.

  - ***Manuscript under review at ACM Computing Surveys***

- **Deepfake Detection Model and Dataset for South Asia**

  Building on the survey, developing a South Asian deepfake dataset and detection model. Currently building an evaluation pipeline to benchmark existing detection models on South Asian content and identify where they fail.

  - *Ongoing research*

Experience

- **Academic Instructor**

University of Colombo School of Computing (UCSC) *April 2026 – Present*

- **Software Developer (Full-time and Part-time)**

Emplity Pvt Ltd - NUS Spin-off Singapore (Remote) *Nov 2024 – May 2026*

  – Frontend developer for an AI-assisted chatbot supporting psychology PhD students at the National University of Singapore.

  – Built the conversational interface and application features in Next.js and TypeScript, from Figma designs to production, applying user-centered design to an AI system used in a sensitive well-being context.

- **Research Assistant**

HCI Lab UCSC *April 2025 – April 2026*

  – Conducted user-centered research with multidisciplinary teams to design and evaluate interventions that improve deepfake literacy in Global South communities.

  – Built prototypes, designed surveys and controlled experiments (Qualtrics, Prolific), and analyzed quantitative and qualitative data (Python, R).

- **Volunteer Researcher**

HCI Lab UCSC *March 2024 – March 2025*

  – Conducted research on HCI, AI policy design, and technology adoption with researchers from The Open University, UK, contributing literature reviews, analysis, and study procedures.

Conferences and Workshops

- **The Trust and Safety Research Conference, Stanford University USA**

Presented the research paper in the session on "Digital Intersectionality in the Majority World.

- **CHI 2025, Yokohama, Japan**

Presented the AI-content labeling research paper and facilitated a panel discussion on Bridging Gaps in HCI: Advancing Education, Research, and Careers in Asia

- **High-Level Stakeholder Consultation on AI in Policy and Governance**

Invited participant, representing UCSC | Hilton Colombo, Sri Lanka *22 Jan 2026*

  – Closed-door dialogue under *Bridging Borders Through AI* (supported by Canada in India, Nepal & Bhutan, with Humber Polytechnic, Canada).

- **3rd ACM Europe Digital Humanism Summer School, TU Wien, Austria (2024)**

Explored EU AI Act, AI ethics, Degenerative Democracy, Trustworthy AI and Sustainable development and challenges of the Global South along with hands-on work with AI tools provided by the European Union.

- **Winter School by Colombo ACM SIGCHI Chapter, Sri Lanka**

Human-centered AI, experimental design, and research ethics.

- **ICWSM 2025, Copenhagen, Denmark**

Presented a working paper at ICWSM-Global on deepfakes.

Skills

Programming & Frameworks: Python, R, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Next.js, React.js.

Research & Data: Experimental and survey design, statistical and qualitative analysis, usability studies, participatory workshops, research ethics.

AI Governance & Safety: Comparative AI/deepfake regulation (South Asia), EU AI Act, AI-content labeling and disclosure, online trust and safety, human-centered and responsible AI.

Tools: Git, GitHub, Figma, Qualtrics, Prolific, Trello.

Leadership

- **IEEE Student Branch UCSC,** Industry Engagement Lead *2023-2024*
- **Rotaract Club of UCSC,** Director - Club Service Avenue *2023-2024*
- **AIESEC in University of Colombo,** Business-to-Business Manager *2022-2023*
- **Women's Hockey & Tennis, UoC,** Inter-Faculty and Freshers' Runners-Up *2023*

References

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